



**Food and Agriculture
Organization of the
United Nations**

BUILDING RESPONSIBLE
GLOBAL VALUE CHAINS
**FOR SUSTAINABLE
TROPICAL FRUITS**

ACTION REPORT

WELCOME!

The FAO led project “Building responsible global value chains for the sustainable production and trade of tropical fruits”, also known as the Responsible Fruits Project, works with businesses, farmer organizations and other actors in the avocado and pineapple value chains. Our goal is to improve business performance by helping these two value chains be more sustainable and more resilient.

OUR GLOBAL FOCUS

- Tropical fruits are mainly produced in developing countries, where they generate jobs and export revenues. Tropical fruits are also part of a healthy diet in both producer and importing countries. Our initial focus on avocado and pineapple is due to the rapid growth in the production and trade of these two fruits.
- The project provides businesses and farmer organizations with technical support and capacity development on pre-competitive issues. It does not provide direct funding.
- As a global project, we do not focus on a specific country or company. Rather, we gather a worldwide network of actors bringing positive change to the production and trade of tropical fruit.



For more information on the benefits of joining this project, please see our [website](#).

ACTIONS

Since its inception event in early 2021, the project has supported activities with the private sector to address sustainability and resilience challenges.

- **Project introductions:**

- To date the project team has reached out to nearly 100 organizations to introduce the project.
- An [inception event](#) for participants from Africa, Europe, the Caribbean, North America, Central America and South America was held in March 2021. Industry participants discussed the business case and good practices for sustainability, as well as concerns related to social, environmental and economic challenges.
- A briefing was organized for members of the International Tropical Fruits Network (TFNet) in Asia. Here 23 organizations in the avocado and pineapple value chains emphasized the growing importance of tropical fruits in the region's trading landscape. A report by TFNet is [available online](#).



- **Baseline survey assessing business actions and concerns around sustainability and resilience:**

The team conducted a survey to identify the current practices and needs of participating companies in terms of sustainability, responsible business conduct (RBC) and resilience. The 36 participating companies came from 13 countries, including the leading producing, exporting and importing countries for both fruits. The results present clear indications about sustainability challenges, current practices in risk analysis and due diligence, the impact of COVID-19 and the importance of building business resilience. Findings are being used to support the design of project interventions and monitor the impact of project activities.

- **Peer-learning technical webinars:**

The project has organized five events to date for peer learning and sharing of good practices. To facilitate open discussion, the reports from the events follow the *Chatham House Rule* — discussion is not attributed to specific individuals — except for the main presenters who have consented to share information in advance. The following topics have been covered:

1. Climate change strategies and carbon footprinting (June 2021)
2. Due diligence and OECD-FAO Guidance for responsible agricultural supply chains to address business risk (July 2021)
3. Eliminating deforestation and forest degradation (October 2021)
4. Baseline survey results (December 2021)
5. Reducing agrochemical use and meeting maximum residue levels (February 2022)

- **Growing awareness of the role of sustainability and resilience** in tropical fruit value chains:

The project has been invited to present at various fora including the ITC-ILO, OECD, TFNet International Symposium on Tropical Fruits, and the Second International Symposium on Durian and Other Tropical Fruits.

COMING UP

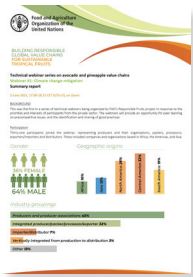
The project team is organizing research, technical support, peer-learning and other capacity development activities for 2022, including:

- More peer-learning webinars on demand-based topics:
 - The next event on 26 April 2022 will focus on sustainable water management in avocado and pineapple value chains.
- Researching deeper into challenges and constraints caused by external shocks (e.g. climate change, COVID, natural disasters) to avocado and pineapple value chains.
- Validating and releasing a technical guide on gap analysis of certification standards and due diligence, to support companies in responding to new due diligence requirements.
- Preparing a technical guide and online tool for carbon and water footprinting, one specific to each of the pineapple and avocado value chains.
- Preparing two commodity specific guides – one for avocado, one for pineapple – adapting the due diligence framework of the [OECD-FAO Guidance for responsible agricultural supply chains](#).
- Mapping the capacity needs of the policy environment in which avocado and pineapple are traded.



Please contact the project team if you would like more information or would like to propose specific topics about sustainability or resilience for the project.

PEER LEARNING TECHNICAL WEBINARS ON AVOCADO AND PINEAPPLE VALUE CHAINS - SUMMARY REPORTS



Climate change mitigation

Climate change mitigation is part of a holistic strategy for sustainability and resilience. Companies and experts discussed tools and methods for climate change mitigation and measuring carbon footprints in avocado and pineapple value chains.

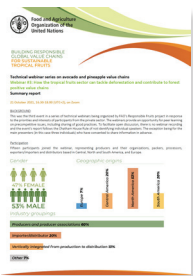
<http://www.fao.org/3/cb6119en/cb6119en.pdf>



The OECD-FAO Guidance for Responsible Agricultural Supply Chains can help the fruit industry deal with business risk

Avocado and pineapple businesses can enhance their sustainability and resilience to external shocks by strengthening their due diligence processes. FAO experts on responsible business conduct discussed due diligence requirements and how the OECD-FAO Guidance can help.

<http://www.fao.org/3/cb8922en/cb8922en.pdf>



How the tropical fruits sector can tackle deforestation and contribute to forest positive value chains

Tropical fruits value chains can address deforestation risks and contribute to forest positive value chains, while continuing to supply healthy products and thrive commercially. Good practices, the current policy/legal environment, and opportunities for forest positive value chains were discussed.

<https://www.fao.org/3/cb8007en/cb8007en.pdf>



Reduction of agrochemical use, sustainable pest and disease management and compliance with MRLs

Producers are making efforts to reduce their reliance on chemical pesticides, adopt more sustainable crop production practices and ensure compliance with maximum residue level (MRL) regulations. Discussion focused on strengthening sustainable pest and disease management practices and MRL compliance.

<http://www.fao.org/3/cb9092en/cb9092en.pdf>

GET IN TOUCH

Markets and Trade Division - Economic and Social Development stream

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